

Q How would you differentiate between enterprise and embedded Linux?

When you refer to embedded Linux, it's got one kernel that anybody can download from kernel.org. It then becomes enterprise Linux or embedded Linux depending on the kind of application you're developing. When you install it on any normal PC, you call it enterprise Linux, but when you use the same kernel for all your embedded applications—mobiles, connected homes, in-vehicle infotainment (IVI), etc, it becomes embedded Linux.



Rajesh Lalwani, account manager,
Wind River

Q Security has emerged as one of the key considerations while developing products and solutions for all companies today, as seen in the case of the recent Heartbleed episode. What are your thoughts on this?

Let's assume that the largest network equipment provider in the world is building a fairly critical application and, that too, on Linux. Assume that there are millions of people who will get impacted if there is a bug in the operating system used. The application needs 99.99999 uptime. The company also needs a team that is ahead of the curve from an open source perspective, but that team still needs to work with a vendor that is conversant in open source and Linux. The vendor has to ensure that any issues found anywhere get patched and fixed in a manner such that the network equipment company is protected and is able to deliver to its customers. I was recently reading some information that was being circulated within Wind River. Heartbleed became known to the public

on 7th April (in Finnish) and 8th April (in English). A fix was available on OLS to our Wind River Linux customers for download on 8th April - less than 24 hours after Heartbleed was introduced to the public domain. If you're running anything that has some level of criticality, you would absolutely need to have that level of security.

Q Can Android challenge embedded Linux?

If you look at the Android kernel, it's a flavour of Linux. There's no challenge as such. The only thing is that there must be interoperability

between Android and Linux. Android is being extensively used on the enterprise side—in mobiles, particularly. Now, to explain embedded Linux, let's look at routers. Here, most things run on VxWorks, or any other RTOS, but you cannot use Android. On the application side, Android is being used on the mobile, tablet or on a few of the IVIs that are coming out.

Many IVIs out there are Android-based and we have a very strong presence in the domain. We are one of the founding members of the Open Handset Alliance (OHA), something that came up even before Android became what it is today!

Q Do you have some engagement opportunities for engineers?

Some of our core Indian customers came to us and expressed their concern about the fact that they were not getting trained engineers to work on our technology. We discussed this issue internally and came out with university licences. We now give the same technology provided by us commercially at a much subsidised price to universities. At the same time, we offer them a programme called Train the Trainer (TTT) to help train faculty members. We also provide them with a curriculum, if they ask for one. We are currently working with a number of key organisations that are writing a curriculum for Indian engineering colleges. **END** 

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